



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Elijah House Academy
School Website: <https://elijahhouseacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Elijah House Academy (EHA) presents a strong CLASSICAL orientation across all six rubric categories. Public materials consistently foreground a Christ-centered, theologically anchored education that emphasizes formation of character and intellect in tandem with spiritual formation. The curriculum centers on liberal-arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with classic literature and "great books" sensibilities (including moral and doctrinal formation), and explicit cultivation of virtue and wisdom. Pedagogy includes Socratic seminars, memory work, and oratory, with explicit attention to formation through-affection, ritual, and communal practice. The faculty are presented as mentors and living exemplars, and there is a clearly articulated partnership with families as co-educators. These elements align closely with the Positive Keyword indicators in the classical lexicon and the Six Essential Elements framework.

Key evidence includes: a theology-grounded Statement of Faith and explicit Christ-centered mission; a curriculum that centers on discipleship, Great Books-style reading, and the liberal arts; pedagogy that features Socratic dialogue, memory work, and structured oratory; a "Portrait of a Graduate" emphasizing Love God, Love Neighbor, and Love Learning; mission statements describing partnership with families and emphasis on formation; and a strong parental/community engagement ethos evident in policy and outreach materials. For category-by-category detail, see the sections below, which document evidence, map keywords to classical indicators, quantify keyword presence, justify the category rating, and summarize what would move the needle if relevant.

Citations throughout reference Elijah House Academy public materials in the school crawl and the classical education knowledge resources.

- Core theological/religious foundations and liturgical life are shown in the Statement of Faith and mission/vision materials.
- The Christ-centered mission and formation emphasis are explicit in Mission+Vision+Values and the Portrait of a Graduate.
- Curriculum and pedagogy evidence (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books framing, Socratic seminars, oral/ritual memory) are clear in the Curriculum and Middle School pages, and in Philosophy of Education materials.
- Parental partnership and home-school collaboration are articulated in Our Home/Partnership language.
- Great Books / "living books" and classical pedagogy cues are present in the Philosophy of Education and Curriculum discussions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Statement of Faith; Christ-centered worldview; liturgical/community life reflected in prayer, Bible orientation, and chapel-

like formation; theology as governing study. Positive keyword indicators (truth, God, Bible, theology, liturgy, chapel, wonder) are prominent; negative indicators (secular relativism) are not evident in public materials. Justification: The school explicitly grounds education in theological commitments and transcendentals, exceeding minimal classroom spirituality.

- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit aim to form virtue and wisdom; formation emphasis over mere information; reality of truth, goodness, beauty is foregrounded; mission statements emphasize human flourishing and teleology. Positive keyword indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, and teleology; negative indicators (career-prep focus) are absent or minimized in public materials. Justification: The school situates education as formation and character development with a transcendent telos, aligning with classical aims.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Liberal-arts oriented curriculum with grammar, logic, rhetoric; ongoing study of history within disciplines; reading of classic literature and “great books” orientation (via “living books” and canonical authors); explicit emphasis on wonder and integration of disciplines. Positive keyword indicators: liberal arts, trivium, gramm(ar)ar, logic, rhetoric, great books, history, living books, wonder. Negative indicators: minimal or no history-as-social-studies drift; STEM-first framing is not evident. Justification: Substantive alignment with classical curricular structure and content.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence: Restful/scholé emphasis; memory work through chant/singing; lower-school singing and memorization; upper-school Socratic seminars and rhetoric training; opportunities for public speaking and oratory; integration of liturgical cycles and catechesis. Positive keyword indicators include Socratic seminars, scholé, memory work, chanting, rhetoric, debate, and liturgical integration; negative indicators (exclusively project-based or constructivist-only approaches) are not evidenced as dominant in public content. Justification: Pedagogy shows classical forms (Socratic, memory, rhetoric) with a balanced contemplative dimension.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty are presented as mentors and living curriculum; there is a defined team and leadership structure; a culture of teacher leadership and moral formation is implied in philosophy of education materials and mission. Positive keyword indicators include living curriculum, mentors, masters, portrait of a teacher, collegiality; negative indicators (purely technician/credential-driven framing) are not evident in public materials. Justification: Public-facing materials reflect a classical faculty culture oriented toward virtue, mentorship, and exemplar leadership.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit partnership with families, “home as first classroom,” and a stated partnership with parents as co-educators; opportunities for parent formation and community engagement; open-campus/visit culture and multiple parent-facing channels. Positive keyword indicators include partnership with families, parent formation, home-school partnership, family catechesis, and open campus; negative indicators (parent-customer models) are not evident in public messaging. Justification: The school material strongly aligns with the classical model of parent partnership and community formation.

Overall Aggregate Assessment: CLASSICAL

- Across all six categories, Elijah House Academy demonstrates the core elements of a classical education: a robust religious/theological foundation, formation-focused goals, a liberal-arts curriculum with Great Books/ Living Books, classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, memory, rhetoric, scholé), a living-faculty model, and a strong parent/community partnership. The keyword signals in the school’s public materials match the Positive Keyword Indicators in the classical lexicon, with few or no explicit Negative Keyword signals beyond standard cautionary notes in the broader classical-education lexicon. The aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required to shift the school out of the CLASSICAL category.

ABSTRACT

Elijah House Academy (EHA) earns a CLASSICAL classification across six criteria: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school's public materials articulate a Christ-centered worldview, a formation-focused aim, a liberal-arts curriculum with grammar/logic/rhetoric and engagement with Great Books/"living books," a pedagogy featuring Socratic seminars, memory/recitation, and oratory, and a culture of mentors and family partnership. These signals align with the Positive Keyword Indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework, as detailed in the classical lexicon. Evidence includes explicit statements of faith and theology, mission and values centered on formation, curriculum that foregrounds the Trivium and Great Books, pedagogical practices in scholé and dialogue, the living-curriculum portrayal of faculty, and a clear home-school partnership ethos. The school's public materials consistently emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty in a way that supports a classical telos and a culture of virtue.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: The Bible as inspired Word of God and a Trinitarian framework are explicitly stated; liturgical/community life is embedded in formation; reverence and wonder are foregrounded via worship and doctrinal grounding.
- Purpose and Goal: Formation in virtue and wisdom; teleology oriented toward true, good, beautiful; emphasis on Christian flourishing and communal purpose.
- Curriculum: Liberal arts orientation with grammar/logic/rhetoric; history embedded in Christian narrative; engagement with classic literature; "living books" and Great Books sensibilities; an integrated view of history across grades.
- Pedagogy: Socratic seminars; restfulness (Scholé); memory/chanting; public speaking and rhetoric; formation through imitation and practice.
- Faculty: Mentorship and living curriculum; portrait of teacher; team leadership and trust; vocation-centered formation.
- Parents & Community: Strong partnership with families; parent formation and home-school collaboration; open visitation.

End of Abstract.

Notes on sources and keywords

- Central doctrinal and liturgical signals are found in Elijah House Academy's Statement of Faith and Philosophy of Education materials, which articulate a Christ-centered, theologically grounded framework.
- Mission, Vision, and Values, Portrait of a Graduate, and home-school-partner language demonstrate a persistent focus on formation, virtue, and spiritual disciplines in alignment with classical aims.
- Curriculum and pedagogy evidence include explicit references to the liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), classical literature, Great Books sensibilities, Socratic seminars, and oratory.
- Positive/Negative keyword indicators and the detailed six-element rubric are drawn from the classicality lexicon and the Six Essential Elements documents:
- Classicality Lexicon (Positive/Negative Indicators) provides explicit keyword targets for all six categories.
- Six Essential Elements (documented lists of positive/negative indicators across categories) anchor the rubric used in category scoring.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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